

Briefing kit — quick layout edits, then Flutter

Menus, block placement and alignment during a briefing, transferred to the portal afterwards

Setting: in person or screen-share, you drive, colleagues watch · Decided 9 September 2026

Two speeds. **Menus** are edited live in the running Flutter app — a 3–5 s hot reload, nothing to transfer. **Block placement** is done by dragging on a design canvas rebuilt from the portal's own tokens, saved as a shared link, and carried into Flutter by a scripted task with the audit crawl as the check. Figma stays the token source only.

MENU CHANGE ROUND
TRIP

3–5 s

edit `nav_model.dart`, hot
reload

CANVAS ARTBOARDS

5

Overview · Profile · My
Outputs · Dashboard ·
Review queue

CANVAS → FLUTTER
LOOP

< 20 min

extract, Codex task,
crawl check

NEW TOOLS FOR
COLLEAGUES

0

they watch a screen or
open a link

Why not Figma or plain HTML

Option	Verdict	Reason
Figma (Carmela's UNIDCOM.fig)	tokens only	Colleagues do not use it; Figma → Flutter is manual; the file already gave us the tokens in <code>lib/theme/tokens.dart</code> .
Plain HTML in a browser + devtools	no	Edits vanish on reload, nothing to hand to the next step, no shared link.
Flutter hot reload	menus	The IA is already data (<code>nav_model.dart</code>); no transfer step at all.
Claude Design canvas (Artifact)	layout	Drag, resize, retype, Save; link opens without an account; PNG/PDF export; working files live in the repo.

Path 1 — menus and IA, live in the app

Step	What	Where
1	Run the portal locally	<code>flutter run -d chrome --web-port 8080 · r reload, R restart</code>
2	Add, move, rename, regroup rows	<code>lib/widgets/nav_model.dart</code> — groups → rows → routes
3	Section landing pages and placeholder leaves	<code>lib/app/portal_pages.dart</code> (<code>WipPage</code>)
4	Show or hide a feature for the pilot	<code>lib/data/features.dart</code> (v1 / v2 flag)
5	Before committing	<code>flutter test test/nav_model_test.dart</code> — fails if a row points at a route that does not exist

Rule: a row needs a route; a new route needs a builder in `lib/main.dart`.

Path 2 — block placement and alignment, on the canvas

Step	What	Notes
Build once	Five artboards at 1280 × 900, pixel-exact from the Flutter tokens and Carmela's HTML exports; sidebar as one shared component	<code>design/canvas/*.dc.html</code> in the repo, sample data only
In the briefing	Drag cards, change widths, reorder rows, retype labels; Save when agreed	Saved versions are kept and attributed; PNG export for the minutes
Afterwards	Extract the saved artboards, diff against the repo copy	The diff is the change list
Transfer	One Codex task per screen: "make <code>lib/app/<file>.dart</code> match <code><Screen>.dc.html: ...</code> ", with a widget test	Same pattern as the round-5 fixes
Check	Rebuild, crawl the touched screens, compare screenshot with the artboard export	<code>audit/tools/crawl.py</code>
Close	Commit the extracted artboards back to <code>design/canvas/</code>	Canvas and app stay in step

Limits to know

- One editor at a time saves cleanly; two saving at once means the second reloads and re-applies. Fine for a driven briefing.
- The canvas is a mockup: it does not run the app's data. Anything that depends on real rows is checked in the transfer step, not on the canvas.
- Menu changes made on the canvas still go into `nav_model.dart` by hand — that path is faster than any transfer.

Dry run before the first real briefing

Move the Overview **Alerts** card under **Quick links**, rename **Recent papers** to **Recent outputs**, Save → extract → Codex task for `lib/app/researcher_home.dart` → crawl `r_home` → screenshot matches the artboard → commit. Target: under 20 minutes end to end.

Prerequisites verified 9 September: Node 24 on the audit machine; the artifact roster allows Save and PNG/PDF export. Deliverables of the build step: `docs/briefing-kit.md` (runbook), `design/canvas/` (artboards + README), the published canvas link.